

Top Local & Regional SBA Lenders

These institutions have a strong physical presence in Houston and are among the most active in the region as of early 2026.

- **Wallis Bank:** A top-ranked local lender that provided nearly **\$60 million** in local SBA loans in the 12 months ending June 2025. They offer 7(a) and 504 programs for real estate, equipment, and working capital.
- **Frost Bank:** An SBA Preferred Lender that recently noted a "thawing" in the lending market for 2026. They emphasize local expertise and faster decision-making for business growth loans.
- **Amegy Bank:** Provides SBA 7(a) loans up to **\$5 million** and specialized 504 loan options. They currently offer introductory fixed rates as low as **6.99%** for certain business financing products.
- **Texas Capital Bank:** An active Preferred Lender in Texas offering 7(a) loans ranging from **\$500,000 to \$5,000,000** with terms up to 25 years.
- **Stellar Bank:** Offers both 7(a) and 504 financing through dedicated partnerships with the SBA to fuel small business expansion.
- **Golden Bank:** Features delegated authority to approve 7(a) loans directly, which can reduce approval times by **two weeks or more**.

Credit Unions & Specialized Sources

- **Houston Federal Credit Union (HFCU):** Specializes in larger SBA loans from **\$300,000 to \$5,000,000**. Their 7(a) program specifically focuses on loans fully collateralized by real property.
- **Smart Financial Credit Union:** Offers various business loan products with a focus on community-based member service.
- **Southwestern National Bank:** A community-focused business bank in Houston providing innovative financial solutions for local entrepreneurs.

Major National Lenders with Houston Offices

These high-volume lenders often handle the largest number of SBA applications in the Houston market.

- **Live Oak Bank:** Nationally one of the largest SBA 7(a) lenders, providing over **\$57 million** to the Houston area in the most recent fiscal period.
- **Newtek Bank:** Ranked #1 for local SBA loan value in Houston (ending June 2025) with over **\$70 million** in approved funding.
- **Huntington Bank:** A top national lender by approval count, known for supporting startups and construction projects with dedicated draw teams.
- **Bank of America:** A major PLP lender that provides specialized small business specialists for the 7(a) application process.